New Joiner Onboarding Handbook

Welcome to Northwind Logistics. This handbook is maintained by HR and IT and is given to every new joiner on the first working day.

Chapter 1. Welcome to Northwind

Northwind Logistics was founded in 2009 in Rotterdam and now employs 2,311 people. The company operates from 7 sites: Rotterdam, Hamburg, Antwerp, Lyon, Milan, Warsaw and Austin.

Our Chief Executive Officer is Marta Veldkamp, our CFO is Jonas Albrecht, our CTO is Priya Raman and our CISO is Tomasz Kowalski. HR is led by Elena Rossi.

Our four values are reliability, openness, safety and curiosity. They are discussed in chapter 10.

Chapter 2. Your first week

On your first day, report to reception at 09:00 to collect your access badge. The safety induction starts at 11:00 and takes about 90 minutes.

Day 2 is reserved for IT setup and system accounts. Day 3 is a depot visit for office-based staff. On Day 4 you meet your buddy, a colleague who has been with Northwind for at least 12 months. On Day 5 you review your 30-60-90 day plan with your line manager.

Laptops are issued on the first working day and must be returned within 5 working days of your last day of employment.

Chapter 3. IT and security

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long and are changed every 180 days. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, the VPN and the Harbour portal.

Report lost devices to the Security Operations Centre immediately. The Security Incident Response Plan explains severity levels and escalation. Never share your password, even with IT staff.

IT support is available on Monday to Friday from 07:30 to 18:00 CET at helpdesk ext. 4000.

Chapter 4. Working hours and timekeeping

The standard working week is 38 hours, with core hours from 10:00 to 15:00. Office staff record time in the Harbour portal by Friday 12:00 each week.

Overtime must be approved in advance by the line manager. Warehouse and depot staff clock in at the gate terminal at the start and end of each shift.

The probation period is 6 months for all new joiners. During probation either party may end the contract with 1 month's notice.

Chapter 5. Benefits overview

Health insurance is provided under plan code BEN-HLT-01 from the first day of employment. The complete list of benefits, the employer share and any waiting periods are in the benefits table maintained by HR.

Employees who do not hold a parking permit can claim a public transport pass. Employees in the Netherlands and Belgium may lease a bicycle. Details of eligibility are in the benefits table.

Chapter 6. Leave

New joiners receive 24 days of annual leave, as set out in the leave policy. Leave is booked in the Harbour portal at least two weeks before the planned absence. Sick leave must be reported to your line manager before the start of your shift.

Public holidays are published every November. Please read the current leave policy carefully; HR can answer questions at hr@northwind-logistics.example.

Chapter 7. Health and safety

7.1 Everyone on a depot floor must wear safety shoes and a high-visibility vest. Report every near miss to the depot safety officer within the same shift.

7.2 Each depot has a first-aid room, and the Rotterdam depot has 14 certified first aiders.

7.3 In case of a life-threatening situation on any Northwind site, call the site emergency line 0800-555-0112 first and the Rotterdam control room on +31 10 555 0199 second.

Chapter 8. Expenses and travel

Business travel is booked through the NorthTravel tool and claimed through NorthExpense. Please read the Expense Policy and the Travel Guidelines before your first trip.

Meals during domestic travel are reimbursed up to EUR 45 per day. The Expense Policy contains the current limits for hotels, taxis and entertainment.

Corporate cards are issued after the completion of probation.

Chapter 9. Training and performance

The mandatory data protection course takes 60 minutes and must be completed within your first 30 days. The safe handling course takes 4 hours and is mandatory for everyone working on a depot floor.

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in April and October. Your line manager sets goals with you during the first month.

Training budget and learning resources are listed in the benefits table.

Chapter 10. Culture and values

We believe in reliability: a parcel promised is a parcel delivered. We believe in openness: share problems early. We believe in safety: nobody should be hurt moving a parcel. We believe in curiosity: ask why a process exists before you change it.

Each year on 3 June the company closes for Founders' Day. Teams also hold a quarterly social event with a budget of EUR 40 per person.

Chapter 11. Who to contact

Topic	Contact	Extension
HR and leave	Elena Rossi	4100
Finance and expenses	Finance Helpdesk	4120
IT support	IT Helpdesk	4000
Security incidents	Security Operations Centre	4142
Facilities	Rotterdam Facilities Desk	4150